ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

REPORT ON THE NKULUMANE

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

BY-ELECTION HELD ON 20 DECEMBER 2025

Executive Summary 3
Chapter 1 THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION 5
1.1 Composition 5
1.2 Functions of the Commission 6
1.3 Additional Functions 7
Chapter 2 BUDGET 8
2.1 Budget Control 8
Chapter 3 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS 9
3.1 Proclamation 6 of 2025. Statutory Instrument 169A of 2025 9
3.2 Voter Education 9
3.3 Nomination Court Results 9
3.4 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates 10
3.5 Multiparty Liaison Committees 10
3.6 Polling Stations 10
3.7 Ballot Paper Printing 10
3.8 Transport 11
3.9 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers 11
3.10 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel 11
Chapter 4 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING 12
4.1 Polling 12
4.2 Assisted Voters 12
4.3 Turned Away Voters 13
4.4 Verification and Counting 13
4.5 Transmission and Results of Poll 13
4.6 The Environment 14
Chapter 5 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION 15
5.1 Motor Vehicles 15
5.2 Ward Boundary 15
5.3 Conclusion 15

Executive Summary

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.

3. Following the notification of a vacancy which arose in the National Assembly due to the passing on, of the Nkulumane Constituency legislator, the President issued **Proclamation 6 of 2025 under Statutory Instrument 169A of 2025** calling for by-elections to be held on 20 December 2025.

4. The Commission had requested a budget of 21 million ZWG and was allocated ZWG20 000 000 for the by-election.

5. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The key messages for pre-nomination voter education focused on what caused the by-election and the required qualifications for aspiring candidates. The pre-polling key messages focused on how to vote.

6. The Nomination Court to receive nomination papers for aspiring candidates to stand for election as member of the National Assembly sat on 20 November 2025.

   At the close of the sitting of the Nomination Court the results were as follows:

	Constituency	**Name**	**Sex**	**Party**
1	Nkulumane	Fuzwayo Mbuso	M	Independent
2		Jele Rodney Donovan	M	Independent
3		Moyo Alson	M	EFF
4		Murechu Freedom P.	M	ZANU PF
5		Ncube-Malaba Nompilo	F	ZANC
6		Ndlovu Muthusi	M	CCC
7		Sibanda Ethel	F	MDC-T
8		Siziba Vivian Viyo	M	ZAPU
9		Zitha Ester Excellia	F	Independent

7. A total of twenty-two thousand eight hundred and thirty-three (22 833) ballot papers were printed for the National Assembly by-election. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

8. The Commission established thirty-four (34) polling stations for voting purposes. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

9 The Commission used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-election.

10. The training of different levels of electoral officers was conducted from 8 to 18 December 2025.

11. Six (6) applications for the accreditation of observers and media practitioners were received.

12. The by-election was held on 20 December 2025 and results were announced on 21 December 2025.

13. Murechu Freedom P. of ZANU PF party was declared the winner after the poll.

14. The 20th December 2025 by-election was held under peaceful conditions and no cases of politically motivated incidents were received by the Commission.

Chapter 1

1.0 THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

1.1 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of a Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight (8) other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve (12) nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-election, the Commission consisted of eight (8) members as follows:

1. Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba Chairperson
2. Ambassador Rodney Simukai Kiwa - Deputy Chairperson
3. Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi- Ambrose - Commissioner
4. Ms Catherine Mpofu - Commissioner
5. Mrs Rosewita Murutare - Commissioner
6. Mr Jasper Mangwana - Commissioner
7. Dr Janet Mbetu Nzvenga - Commissioner
8. Dr Kudzai Shava - Commissioner

1.2 Functions of the Commission

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

(i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

(ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

(iii) elections of Members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

(iv) referendums;

and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a) undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters

b) developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and

c) promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and

d) keeping the public informed about -

   i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and

   ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and

   iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and

   iv. voters roll and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and

   v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;

   vi. voting; and

   vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

(d1) ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

(e) making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

Chapter 2

2.0 BUDGET

The Commission had requested a total of 21million ZWG for the by-election and was allocated $20million.

2.1 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines as required by the law.

Chapter 3

3.0 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

3.1 Proclamation 6 of 2025. Statutory Instrument 169A of 2025

Following the notification of a vacancy which arose in Parliament due to the death of the Citizens Coalition for Change (CCC) Member of the National Assembly for Nkulumane constituency Honourable Desire Moyo on 10 October 2025, the President issued Proclamation 6 of 2025 calling for a by-election in the said constituency to be held on 20 December 2025.

3.2 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-election as from 12 to 16 November 2025 and 11 to 15 December 2025 respectively. The key messages for the pre-nomination phase centred on what had caused the by-election and who qualified to be a candidate in the elections. The pre-polling voter education emphasised on notifying the electorate on knowing the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, the voting process and how to cast a vote, assisted and redirected voters and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate. These included the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of the Public Address (PA) System.

3.3 Nomination Court Results

The Nomination Court to receive nomination papers from aspiring candidates to stand for election as Member of National Assembly sat on the 20th of November 2025.

The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the Nomination Court:

Persons Nominated for Election

	Constituency	Name	Sex	Party
1	Nkulumane	Fuzwayo Mbuso	M	Independent
2		Jele Rodney Donovan	M	Independent
3		Moyo Alson	M	EFF
4		Murechu Freedom P.	M	ZANU PF
5		Ncube-Malaba Nompilo	F	ZANC
6		Ndlovu Muthusi	M	CCC
7		Sibanda Ethel	F	MDC-T
8		Siziba Vivian Viyo	M	ZAPU
9		Zitha Ester Excellia	F	Independent

3.4 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates

The contesting candidates were issued with copies of the Nkulumane National Assembly constituency voters' roll. An analysable electronic voters' roll was placed at provincial, district and ward centres for access by the public.

3.5 Multiparty Liaison Committees

Three (3) Multiparty Liaison Committee meetings were held. The meetings were successfully conducted. All the outstanding issues concerning the conduct of the by-elections were discussed and resolved.

3.6 Polling Stations

A total of thirty-four (34) polling stations were established for the by-election.

3.7 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of twenty-two thousand eight hundred and thirty-three ballot papers (**22 833**) were printed for the 20 December 2025 by-election by the Printing and Minting Company of Zimbabwe (PMCZ). This information was publicised in terms of the law.

3.8 Transport

The Commission used its own vehicle fleet for the by-elections. Each polling station was allocated a vehicle. This made the process of deployment, transmission of results and decamping manageable.

3.9 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-election were drawn from the ZEC Secretariat and the Public Service Commission. The recruitment and training of Electoral Officers was done between 8 and 18 December 2025.

The deployment of electoral officers took place prior to their training sessions. Training of polling officers was done at polling station level. The Zimbabwe Republic Police (ZRP) officers were deployed alongside electoral staff to provide security. The setting up of polling stations and rehearsals were done a day before polling.

3.10 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

The accreditation of observers and the media started after the publication of the proclamation of the elections. A total of thirty-seven (37) observers and media personnel were accredited to observe the elections. The accreditation team was deployed at ZEC Bulawayo Metropolitan Provincial Office. The following categories were accredited:

Accreditation Breakdown by Category

Category	Organisation	Total accredited
Observers	Bulawayo Residents Trust Zimbabwe Human Rights Commission ZIMRIGHTS	9 7 7
Media	Alpha Media Kalasizwe (CITE) Zimbabwe Broadcasting Corporation	2 5 7
Grand Total		**37**

Chapter 4

4.0 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

4.1 Polling

Polling took place on 20 December 2025 commencing from 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue of persons waiting to vote as at 1900 hours would be turned away.

All the polling stations opened on time and were adequately staffed by electoral officers including agents, observers. The police details were deployed to provide security and performed other duties as provided by the law.



Only one (1) distinctly marked ballot box for was set up in each polling station.

4.2 Assisted Voters

The below table shows the number by gender of persons assisted to vote in the constituency during the by-election: -

Constituency	***M***	***F***	***Total***
Nkulumane National Assembly	57	131	**188**

The illiterate, the elderly and the visually challenged voters who were not able to vote without assistance were assisted by persons of their choice in compliance with the law. A person who did not bring an assistant was assisted by the Presiding Officer in the presence of two polling officers and the police officer on duty.

4.3 Turned Away Voters

The constituency had a total of four hundred and twenty (420) turned away voters broken down as follows: -

Constituency	***M***	***F***	***Total***
Nkulumane	193	227	**420**

The reasons for turning away voters were due to non-possession of identity cards, wrong documentation and not appearing on the voters' roll among others.

4.4 Verification and Counting

The counting of the votes was preceded by the verification of ballots which process was administered at polling station level by the Presiding Officers in the presence of candidates, observers and election agents. The verification and counting of polling station results was completed on polling day, the 20th of December 2025. The polling station results were posted outside the polling stations.

4.5 Transmission and Results of Poll

The results were transmitted from the polling stations to the Ward Command Centres for collation. The Ward collated results were posted outside the Ward Collation Centres. The Ward Elections Officers then transmitted the ward results for collation at the constituency collation centre. The Constituency Elections Officer collated and announced the constituency results on the 21st of December 2025. The constituency collated results were posted outside the Constituency Collation Centre.

The summary of the results for the by-election was as shown in the table:

Constituency	Candidates	Sex	Party	Votes	
Nkulumane	Fuzwayo Mbuso	M	Independent	121	
	Jele Rodney Donovan	M	Independent	745	
	Moyo Alson	M	EFF	65	
	Murechu Freedom P.	***M***	***ZANU PF***	***3416***	***Winner***
	Ncube-Malaba Nompilo	F	ZANC	18	
	Ndlovu Muthusi	M	CCC	320	
	Sibanda Ethel	F	MDC-T	23	
	Siziba Vivian Viyo	M	ZAPU	110	
	Zitha Ester Excellia	F	Independent	325	
		Total Valid Votes Cast		**5143**	
		Total Votes Rejected		**36**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for		**0**	
		Total Votes Cast		**5179**	
		Voter Population		**22833**	
		Percentage Poll		**22.7%**	

Comparison of 2023 Harmonised Elections and 2025 By-elections Voter Turn-out

Nkulumane	**Moyo Desire**	**M**	**CCC**	**9880**
	Mhlanga Adelaide	F	FREEZIM CONGRESS	101
	Mtetwa Floridah Deliah	F	UZA	151
	Bhebhe Nompilo	F	ZANC	177
	Murechu Freedom Phineas	M	ZANU PF	2402
	Ndlovu Andrew	M	ZAPU	465
		Total Valid Votes Cast		**13176**
		Total Votes Rejected		**122**
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for		**0**
		Total Votes Cast		**13298**
		Voter Population		**22680**
		Percentage Poll		**58.60%**

There was a 35.9% variance between the 2023 and the 2025 voter turn-out. The attributable factors for the low voter turn out could include voter apathy and the by-elections being perceived as of lesser importance and lacking high-stakes.

4.6 The Environment

The elections were held under calm and peaceful conditions. The Commission did not receive any report on politically motivated incidents.

Chapter 5

5.0 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made observations and recommendations as presented below:

5.1 Motor Vehicles

Observation

The current NP300 fleet has served two general elections and subsequent by-elections making its service and maintenance costly.

Recommendation

The Commission recommends that Treasury should avail funding for the procurement of all-terrain vehicles.

5.2 Ward Boundary

Observation

Most voters still require information on their polling areas and ward boundaries following the creation of new boundaries occasioned by the 2022 Delimitation Exercise.

Recommendation

The Commission recommends the provision of funding for continuous voter education on the 2022 Delimitation new ward and constituency boundaries

5.3 Conclusion

Generally, the 20 December 2025 by-election was conducted in a peaceful manner. The Commission consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive, transparent and credible.

The Commission was satisfied that the 20 December 2025 Nkulumane National Assembly by-election was conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed: ……. Date: ……....

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

ZEC Chairperson



ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION